

Explain It Like You Built It

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target="_blank" and rel="noopener noreferrer"

The **target="_blank"** attribute is an HTML command used on the link tag (<a>) to instruct the browser to open the destination page in a new tab (or new window), instead of loading the content in the current tab where the user is already browsing.

There is a risk in using this command without the proper protection: when the user clicks the link, if the destination page has no security measures in place, a bad actor can run an invisible script that changes the address of your original tab in the background. When the user goes back to that tab, they think they were accidentally logged out, type their password again, and it gets stolen.

The fix: **rel="noopener noreferrer"**. To close this security gap, the web community created a safeguard, which is exactly what I added to my site's footer.

- **noopener:** cuts the umbilical cord between the tabs. It tells the browser: “open the new tab, but set window.opener to null.” The new page loses any access to or control over the previous tab.
- **noreferrer:** does the same thing as noopener, but adds a layer of privacy. It hides from the destination site where the click came from — LinkedIn, for example, won't know the exact address of my site, only that it was a “direct visit.”

Why the "back to Portuguese" link uses ../index.html

The **../** is a universal file-system convention that represents the parent directory (the folder that contains the current folder).

Anatomy of the path:

- **.** (a single dot): means the current folder.
- **..** (two dots): means the parent folder (go back one level).
- **/** (slash): acts as the separator between folders.